

STATE OF MICHIGAN
IN THE THIRD JUDICIAL CIRCUIT FOR THE COUNTY OF WAYNE
FAMILY DIVISION, DOMESTIC RELATIONS

ADRIENNE MARJORIE ROCKENHAUS,
Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant,

v.

CONRAD ALAN ROCKENHAUS,
Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff.

Case No. **26-104594-DO**

Hon. **Nicole N. Goodson**

**DEFENDANT/COUNTER-PLAINTIFF'S RESPONSE TO MOTION TO
WITHDRAW AS COUNSEL**

NOW COMES Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff Conrad Alan Rockenhaus, appearing pro se, and respectfully submits this Response to the Motion to Withdraw as Counsel filed by Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC and Lisa R. Baker (P82555) on April 23, 2026 (the "Motion to Withdraw"), as re-noticed for hearing on May 20, 2026 at 9:15 a.m. via Zoom. In support of this Response, Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff states as follows:

INTRODUCTION

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff does not oppose the substantive relief sought by the Motion to Withdraw. The attorney-client relationship between Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC and Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant is a matter between counsel and her client, and Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff takes no position on the grounds asserted by counsel.

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff does, however, respectfully request that any Order granting withdrawal include specific provisions necessary to ensure an orderly post-withdrawal transition and to protect the integrity of the existing case record. This case has substantial pending activity. Eight motions by Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff await calendar assignment. Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant has a pending Motion to Set Aside Default of Counterclaim. Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff's First Set of Interrogatories and First Requests for Production of Documents to Plaintiff are pending without complete response. A Domestic Relations Settlement Conference is scheduled for June 4, 2026. A Motion to Determine Sufficiency, Compel, and for Discovery Sanctions is in preparation by Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff for filing on or about May 19, 2026. The Court's Order should account for these realities so that Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's transition to pro se status does not disrupt the case progression.

I. PROCEDURAL POSTURE

1. On April 23, 2026, counsel for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant filed the Motion to Withdraw, signed by Lisa R. Baker (P82555) on behalf of Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC. The caption of the Motion lists Kenneth R. Burger (P73006) as additional counsel of record. The body of the Motion seeks withdrawal of Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC and Lisa R. Baker as counsel

for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant.

2. On April 29, 2026, this Court held a hearing on Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC's parallel Motion to Withdraw in the related Personal Protection Order matter, Wayne County Case No. 26-102221-PP, and granted that motion on the record.
3. On April 30, 2026, this case was reassigned to the Hon. Nicole N. Goodson by Order following the recusal of the Hon. Yvonna C. Abraham. The Motion to Withdraw in this matter, which had been originally noticed for hearing on May 12, 2026, was vacated and re-calendared.
4. On May 14, 2026, counsel for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant issued a Re-Notice of Hearing setting the Motion to Withdraw for hearing on May 20, 2026 at 9:15 a.m. via Zoom.
5. Between the filing of the Motion to Withdraw and the date of this Response, Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC has remained counsel of record for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant and has continued to act in that capacity. Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC has filed, served, or transmitted, among other documents:
 - a. Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's Answer to Counterclaim, served May 13, 2026, attached as a proposed pleading to the Motion to Set Aside;
 - b. Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's Motion to Set Aside Default of Counterclaim, filed May 13, 2026;
 - c. Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's Answers to Defendant's First Set of Requests for Admissions to Plaintiff, served May 13, 2026;
 - d. Re-Notice of Hearing and Praecept for the Motion to Withdraw, served May 14, 2026.
6. As of the date of this Response, Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant has not filed any Notice of Appearance Pro Se, any substitution of counsel, or any direct communication with the Court or with Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff. Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's current physical address and current email address of record have not been independently verified on the docket.
7. The granting of the Motion to Withdraw will, by operation of MCR 2.117(C)(2), terminate Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC's representation of Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant and shift Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant to pro se status for all further proceedings absent substitution of counsel.

II. DEFENDANT/COUNTER-PLAINTIFF'S POSITION ON THE MOTION

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff does not oppose the substantive relief sought by the Motion to Withdraw. The Motion asserts a breakdown of the attorney-client relationship and breach of the retainer agreement by Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant. Those assertions concern the internal relationship between Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC and its client and are not matters on which Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff has independent knowledge or any procedural interest.

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff also takes no position on the assertion in paragraph 5 of the Motion that "Plaintiff's case will not likely be prejudiced by the withdrawal since the next hearing is not scheduled until June 4, 2026." The prejudice to Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant from the withdrawal of her counsel is a question for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant and for the Court. Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff notes only, and respectfully, that the case has substantial pending activity beyond the June 4, 2026 Settlement Conference, as cataloged in the Introduction above and in Section III below.

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff's interest is in an orderly post-withdrawal transition that preserves the integrity of the existing case record and does not introduce procedural

ambiguity into the docket. To that end, Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff respectfully requests the conditions set forth in Section III.

III. CONDITIONS REQUESTED IN ANY ORDER GRANTING WITHDRAWAL

If the Court is inclined to grant the Motion to Withdraw, Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff respectfully requests that the Order include the following six conditions, each of which is grounded in MRPC 1.16(d) and in the requirements of orderly case administration under MCR 2.117 and MCR 2.107.

A. Verification of Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's Current Address and Email of Record

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff respectfully requests that the Order require Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant to verify on the record, either at the May 20, 2026 hearing or by sworn statement within seven days of entry of the Order, her current physical address and current email address for receipt of all post-withdrawal service of process and case communications. This condition is necessary to establish a reliable post-withdrawal service path under MCR 2.107(C) and MCR 2.107(G). Without verified contact information for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant, Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff cannot reliably effect service of subsequent filings, and the Court cannot reliably effect transmission of orders and notices.

B. Express Preservation of the Operative Status of Aldrich's Prior Filings

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff respectfully requests that the Order include an express provision that all filings entered or served by Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC on behalf of Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant remain operative, binding, and attributable to Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant following withdrawal. This includes, without limitation:

1. Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's Verified Financial Information Form, filed on or about April 22, 2026;
2. Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's Motion to Set Aside Default of Counterclaim, filed May 13, 2026, and the proposed Answer to Counterclaim attached thereto;
3. Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's Answers to Defendant's First Set of Requests for Admissions to Plaintiff, served May 13, 2026; and
4. Any other pleading, motion, notice, discovery response, or stipulation filed or served by Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC on behalf of Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant from the date of Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC's appearance through the date of entry of the Order granting withdrawal.

This condition is necessary to prevent Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant from later disclaiming, withdrawing, or repudiating prior filings of record on the basis that she did not personally execute them. It also preserves the substantive record on which Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff's pending motions and discovery requests have been calibrated.

C. Express Provision That Pending Discovery Obligations Are Not Stayed, Modified, or Extended

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff respectfully requests that the Order expressly state that the withdrawal of Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC does not stay, modify, or extend Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's existing discovery obligations. Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff served, by First Class U.S. Mail and electronic transmission pursuant to MCR 2.107(G), the following discovery requests on April 15, 2026:

1. First Set of Interrogatories to Plaintiff;
2. First Requests for Production of Documents to Plaintiff; and

3. First Set of Requests for Admissions to Plaintiff (responses to which have been served).

Responses to the First Set of Interrogatories and the First Requests for Production of Documents have not yet been served. The deadlines for those responses have either run or are imminent. This condition is necessary to ensure that Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant cannot use the withdrawal of her counsel as a basis to seek further extension of, or relief from, discovery deadlines that have already passed.

D. Production of the Client File to Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant Within Seven Days

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff respectfully requests that the Order direct Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC to deliver Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's complete client file to Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant within seven days of entry of the Order, with simultaneous written notice to Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff confirming the date and manner of such delivery. This condition is grounded in MRPC 1.16(d), which requires withdrawing counsel to take reasonably practicable steps to protect a client's interests, including surrender of papers and property to which the client is entitled. Documenting the production with simultaneous notice to Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff prevents any later claim by Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant that she is unable to respond to outstanding discovery, motions, or notices because she does not have access to her case file.

E. Notice of Appearance Pro Se Within Seven Days

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff respectfully requests that the Order direct Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant to file a Notice of Appearance Pro Se with the Clerk of this Court within seven days of entry of the Order, confirming her current physical address, current email address, and current telephone number for receipt of service. This condition is necessary to establish a clean docket entry of Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant's pro se status and to provide the Court, Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff, and the Clerk with the verified contact information required for ongoing case administration.

F. Reservation of Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff's Rights as to Prejudice

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff respectfully requests that the Order include a reservation of Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff's rights to seek any further relief arising from prejudice caused by the timing of the withdrawal relative to (i) pending discovery deadlines, (ii) the forthcoming Motion to Determine Sufficiency, Compel, and for Discovery Sanctions, and (iii) the eight motions filed by Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff that remain pending calendar assignment in this matter. This condition is a customary reservation and does not require any present finding by the Court; it preserves Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff's procedural options if the post-withdrawal transition produces unanticipated prejudice.

IV. DEFENDANT/COUNTER-PLAINTIFF WILL APPEAR AT THE MAY 20, 2026 HEARING

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff intends to appear at the May 20, 2026 hearing on the Motion to Withdraw, at 9:15 a.m. via Zoom, and will be available to be heard on the requested conditions and on any other matter the Court considers appropriate. Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff respectfully requests that counsel for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant or the Clerk of this Court provide the Zoom appearance information through the established service path identified in counsel's Re-Notice of Hearing or, alternatively, through the publicly posted Zoom information for the Hon. Nicole N. Goodson's courtroom.

V. RELIEF REQUESTED

WHEREFORE, Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff Conrad Alan Rockenhaus respectfully requests that this Honorable Court:

A. To the extent the Court grants the Motion to Withdraw as Counsel filed by Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC and Lisa R. Baker (P82555), include in the Order granting withdrawal each of the six conditions set forth in Section III above;

B. Note Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff's intent to appear at the May 20, 2026 hearing via Zoom; and

C. Grant any other and further relief the Court deems just and equitable.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/ Conrad A. Rockenhaus

Conrad Alan Rockenhaus, Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff Pro Se

1690 Brookfield Drive

Ann Arbor, Michigan 48103

(254) 340-7910

conrad@rockenhaus.net

Date: May 15, 2026

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I, Conrad Alan Rockenhaus, hereby certify that on May 15, 2026, I served a true and correct copy of the foregoing Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff's Response to Motion to Withdraw as Counsel upon counsel of record for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant by two independent modes: (i) electronic transmission pursuant to MCR 2.107(G) to the electronic mail addresses listed below, and (ii) First Class U.S. Mail to the firm's office of record as a courtesy.

Service by Electronic Transmission:

- Lisa Baker, Esq. (P82555), Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC, at lisabaker@aldrichlegalservices.com (counsel of record for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant)
- Kristen Sinkiewicz, Paralegal, Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC, at kris@aldrichlegalservices.com (carbon copy, paralegal at firm of record)

Service by First Class U.S. Mail (Courtesy Copy):

- Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC, Attn: Lisa Baker, Esq. (P82555), 276 South Union Street, Plymouth, MI 48170 (counsel of record for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant)

Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC remains counsel of record for Plaintiff/Counter-Defendant in this matter, and its appearance has not been withdrawn as of the date of this Certificate of Service. Service on counsel of record is proper under MCR 2.107(B)(1). Service by First Class U.S. Mail is complete on mailing under MCR 2.107(C)(3).

I declare under the penalties of perjury that this Certificate of Service has been examined by me and that its contents are true to the best of my information, knowledge, and belief.

Dated: May 15, 2026

/s/ Conrad A. Rockenhaus

Conrad Alan Rockenhaus

Defendant/Counter-Plaintiff Pro Se

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